
SAMPLE PORTFOLIO

What I Need From You

The complete list of content and images required to turn the placeholder website into the real one.

READ SECTION 1 FIRST

It will save you a large amount of unnecessary work.

You do not need all of it

The site has **125 image slots** and about **4,000 words** of placeholder text. That is what a practice with a twenty-year archive fills.

You almost certainly should not try to fill all of it now. An architecture site is judged on the quality of what it shows, not the quantity. **Six well-shot projects with real descriptions beat twelve thin ones**, every time.

So there are two lists in this document: the launch minimum, and the full build. Work to the first. Grow into the second over the next year.

THE LAUNCH MINIMUM

ITEM	QUANTITY	WHY THIS NUMBER
Projects	4–6	Below 4 the grid looks empty; above 6 you start padding
Photos per project	6–10	Fewer than 6 and the page has no rhythm
Home slideshow	3–5	Your strongest single image from each project
Principal portraits	1 each	Non-negotiable — people hire people
Team headshots	0 or all	A half-full grid looks worse than no grid
Firm description	2–3 paras	The most-read text on the whole site
Design philosophy	1–2 paras	How you approach a site and a brief
Project description	2–4 paras each	This is what makes it a portfolio
News / awards / press	0 or what's true	Empty sections get deleted, not padded
Address, phone, emails	all	Currently all placeholder

IN TOTAL

Roughly **45–70 images** and **1,200 words**. Achievable in a week if the photography already exists.

IF A SECTION HAS NOTHING REAL BEHIND IT

Tell me and I will remove it entirely — the page and its navigation tab. A News page with two entries reads as an abandoned site. No News page reads as a deliberate one. This applies to News, Press, Awards, Books and the Team grid.

A · Studio details

Small, but this blocks launch. Every one of these is currently a placeholder, including the phone number and every email address.

#	I NEED	CURRENTLY SAYS
A1	Firm name, exactly as it should appear	Sample Portfolio
A2	Tagline under the logo — 2 to 4 words	Architecture + Interiors
A3	Your domain name, even if unregistered	sampleportfolio.com
A4	Studio street address, as on a letterhead	#00, 00th Main...
A5	Phone number(s) — one or two	+91 00 0000 0000
A6	General email (shown in the footer)	studio@...
A7	New-project enquiries email	projects@...
A8	Careers email	careers@...
A9	Social links — full URLs	Instagram / LinkedIn / Pinterest
A10	Copyright year	2026
A11	Project categories — these become the filter tabs	Residential, Institutional, Hospitality, Workplace, Retail

ON CATEGORIES

Only include a category you have at least one project for. An empty tab reads as a broken site. Five is the current count; three is fine.

B · Home page

#	I NEED	NOTES
B1	3–5 slideshow images	Your single strongest photograph from each of your best projects. Landscape
B2	The same images cropped portrait	Optional — for phones. If you skip this I'll smart-crop the landscape version
B3	Caption for the first slide	A project name, its location and year
B4	Which projects are 'Selected Work'	Up to 6. Or I'll use your first six
B5	One-paragraph practice statement	2–3 sentences, mid-homepage

Images needed: 3–5 landscape, optionally 3–5 portrait.

C · About page

The most important text on the site. A prospective client reads this before they look at a single project.

#	I NEED	LENGTH	NOTES
C1	'The Firm'	2–5 paras	When founded and by whom, what you do, the kind of client, any recognition
C2	'Design Philosophy'	1–2 paras	How you approach a site and a brief. Your voice, not marketing language
C3	Principal: name		
C4	Principal: role title		e.g. 'Founder & Principal'
C5	Principal: biography	2–3 paras	Education, career, awards, speaking, publications
C6	Principal: portrait photo	1	Portrait orientation, head and shoulders
C7	Repeat C3–C6 per principal		Currently set up for two
C8	Team names and roles		Or say 'skip the team section'
C9	Team headshots	all or none	A partial grid looks unfinished

ON TEAM PHOTOS

They display in greyscale and turn colour on hover, which hides a lot of inconsistency in colour but none in framing. They don't need to be professionally lit — but they do need to be **consistent**. Same background, same distance, same rough lighting. Mismatched snapshots are very obvious once they're lined up in a grid.

Images needed: one per principal, plus one per team member (or none at all).

D · Projects

The main body of work. There is a fill-in template — use one copy per project.

TEXT, PER PROJECT

#	FIELD	NOTES
D1	Project name	As you want it titled
D2	Location	City, or city and state
D3	Year completed	
D4	Category	Must be one from A11
D5	Description	2–4 paragraphs minimum. The brief, the site, the response, the materials. This is what separates a portfolio from a photo album
D6	Pull quote	Optional. One sentence lifted from D5, shown large mid-page
D7	Built area	e.g. '640 sqm' — optional
D8	Client	'Private' is fine
D9	Project team	Names of who worked on it
D10	Photographer credit	Ask your photographer before publishing
D11	Feature on homepage?	yes / no

IMAGES, PER PROJECT

#	SLOT	COUNT	FINAL SIZE	NOTES
D12	Cover	1	1200 × 900	The grid thumbnail. Must read at small size
D13	Hero	1	2400 × 1350	Full-width banner. Often your best image
D14	Gallery	6–12	2000 × 1333	The main sequence. Order matters

COVER AND HERO ARE USUALLY DIFFERENT IMAGES

The cover competes with eleven others in a grid, so it needs to be legible at 400px wide — usually a clear, simple, wide shot. The hero has the whole screen, so it can be atmospheric.

Sequencing the gallery

The best project pages read like a walk through the building:

- Arrival and approach
- The exterior, whole building
- The principal space
- Secondary spaces
- A detail — a material, a junction, a piece of joinery
- Something quiet to end on — evening light, a view out

Name your files so they sort in that order: 01-approach.jpg, 02-exterior.jpg, 03-living.jpg.

E · News, Press, Awards, Books

All four of these sections are optional. Tell me which to delete.

#	SECTION	I NEED PER ENTRY	IMAGES?
E1	News highlight	One sentence, a date, an image, a link if there is one	Yes
E2	Press	Publication, article title, author, page range, date	No
E3	Awards	Award name, category, project, and the year to group it under	No
E4	Books	Book title, publisher, city, year	No

News entries read as sentences, not headlines

Good: *“Riverside House wins Best Residential Interior at the 2026 Trends Awards.”*

Not: *“Award Win!”* — that’s a headline, and it says nothing.

THE ONE EXCEPTION TO DELETING EMPTY SECTIONS

If you have even two or three awards, keep the Awards page. It’s the section prospective clients look for, and unlike News it doesn’t look stale when it’s short — an award from 2024 is still an award.

F · Brand assets

#	I NEED	NOTES
F1	Logo files	SVG preferred, otherwise high-res PNG with transparency. Currently the logo is set in type
F2	Brand typeface	Only if the practice has one and you hold a web licence. Otherwise I'll keep Jost + Inter, which are free
F3	Brand colour	Optional. The site is deliberately monochrome so the photography carries the colour. One accent at most
F4	Favicon source	A square mark that reads at 32px — usually a monogram, not the full logo

G · Photography specification

Give me the largest files you have. Do not resize, crop or compress anything first.

The pipeline handles all of it automatically — resolution, colour mode, rotation, cropping, compression, renaming. Every manual edit you make first loses quality it cannot recover.

PROPERTY	WHAT I WANT
File size	The original. 10–15 MB is ideal. 50 MB is fine
Format	JPG, TIFF, PNG, HEIC, WebP — all handled
Resolution	Any. 300 DPI print files convert to 72 DPI automatically
Colour	Any. CMYK print files convert to RGB automatically
Orientation	Any. Camera rotation flags are applied automatically
Minimum width	2400px for heroes, 2000px for gallery. Anything smaller gets upscaled and will look soft

WHAT I CANNOT FIX

- An image that is too small to begin with
- A photograph that is out of focus or badly exposed
- A screenshot of a photograph
- Anything pulled from Instagram or WhatsApp — already compressed and downsized

Always go back to the photographer's original files.

H · Legal and admin

#	ITEM	WHY
H1	Photographer permission	Most architectural photography is licensed, not sold. Publishing without permission is the most common legal problem practices hit
H2	Client permission	Some private clients don't want their house identified or located
H3	Privacy policy	Required in most jurisdictions if you add a contact form
H4	Hostinger login	Only if you want me to walk you through the upload

Suggested order of work

Do it in this sequence. Each step makes the site usable on its own, so you can stop at any point and still have something coherent.

- ☐ **Section A — studio details.** Half an hour, and it removes every fake phone number and email address from the site.
- ☐ **Sections C1–C7 — the firm and the principals.** The highest-value writing you will do.
- ☐ **One complete project** — text and images. This proves the whole pipeline works and gives you a template for the rest.
- ☐ **Three to five more projects.**
- ☐ **Section B — the home page**, chosen from the images you now actually have.
- ☐ **Section E — news and awards**, only if there is something real.
- ☐ **Section F — logo and favicon.**
- ☐ **Sections G and H** — photographer credits and permissions, before you go live.

If something is missing

SITUATION	WHAT I'LL DO
Fewer projects than 12	Delete the extra folders. The grid adapts
No photo for one slot	Leave the neutral grey placeholder — it reads as 'coming soon', not as broken
No project description yet	One honest factual sentence. Never lorem ipsum, which reads as an abandoned site
No team photos	Delete the whole Team section
No awards or press	Delete those pages and their navigation tabs
No logo file	Keep the typographic logo — it suits this design anyway
Photo too small	I'll flag it. You'll need a bigger original — this one I can't work around

THE GOVERNING PRINCIPLE

Ship less, complete. Every visible placeholder costs more credibility than the missing content would have earned. Cut the section instead.

How to send it to me

There are fill-in forms in the **intake** folder. Open them in any text editor, type your answers under each heading, and hand them back. I'll convert them into the format the site needs.

FORM	COVERS	REQUIRED?
01-studio-details	Firm name, address, phone, emails, categories, home page	Yes
02-about	The Firm, Design Philosophy, principals, team	Yes
03-projects	One block per project — copy it 4–6 times	Yes
04-news-press-awards	News, Press, Awards, Books — all optional	No

Images: drop them into the matching folder inside **image-prep/inbox** — there's a short README in each one explaining exactly what it produces — then run the processor. Or just tell me where they are and I'll sort it out.

YOU DON'T HAVE TO FILL IN FORMS

Tell me about a project the way you'd describe it to someone, and I'll draft the copy and hand it back for you to correct. Most people find editing a draft far easier than facing a blank page.

Full reference: [docs/WHAT-I-NEED-FROM-YOU.md](#) · Fill-in forms: [intake/](#) · How to replace things yourself: [docs/06-CONTENT-GUIDE.md](#)